

院/系 _____ 年级 _____ 专业 _____ 姓名 _____ 学号 _____ 座位号 _____

安徽大学 2024—2025 学年第 二 学期
《大学英语 (A) II》期中考试试卷 (B 卷)
(闭卷 时间 120 分钟)

考场登记表序号 _____

题 号	I	II	III	IV	总分
得 分					
阅卷人					

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 points, 1 point each)

得分

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D) and mark your answers on the ANSWER SHEET.

News report 1

Questions 1 and 3 are based on the news report you have just heard.

1. C

- A) It will affect people living in developed countries.
- B) It will change people's attitudes towards their lives.
- C) It has an impact on the future of humankind.
- D) It will affect people living in very poor countries.

2. A

- A) The Caribbean has just been struck by hurricanes caused by climate change.
- B) The Caribbean is the most seriously affected by climate change.
- C) The whole army located in the Caribbean is lost.
- D) The Caribbean is the only region affected by climate change.

3. 13

- A) Because the climate science panel needs more investment than expected.
- B) Because there is a funding gap caused by the US withdrawal.
- C) Because the US president doesn't want to spend more on the climate research.
- D) Because they are very rich European countries.

News report 2

Questions 4 and 6 are based on the news report you have just heard.

4. C

- A) International treaties regarding space travel programs.
- B) Legal issues involved in commercial space exploration.
- C) US government's approval of private space missions.
- D) Competition among public and private space companies.

5. 13

- A) Deliver scientific equipment to the moon.
- B) Approve a new mission to travel into outer space.
- C) Work with federal agencies on space programs.
- D) Launch a manned spacecraft to Mars.

6. A

- A) It is significant.
- B) It is promising.
- C) It is unpredictable.
- D) It is unprofitable.

News report 3

Questions 7 and 8 are based on the news report you have just heard.

7. 13

- A) Annoyed.
- B) Scared.
- C) Confused.
- D) Offended.

8. D

- ☒ A) It crawled over the woman's hands.
- ☒ B) It wound up on the steering wheel.
- ☒ C) It was killed by the police on the spot.
- ☒ D) It was covered with large scales.

Section B

Directions: In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversations and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question. You must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D) and mark your answers on the ANSWER SHEET.

Conversation 1

Questions 9 to 12 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

9. C

- A) She received a bonus unexpectedly.
- ☒ B) She got a well-paid job in a bank.
- ☒ C) She received her first monthly salary.
- D) She got a pay raise for her performance.

10. D

- A) Two decades ago.
- B) Several years ago.
- ☒ C) Just last month.
- D) Right after graduation.

11. B

- A) He sent a small check to his parents.
- ☒ B) He treated his parents to a nice meal.
- ☒ C) He took a few of his friends to a gym.
- D) He immediately deposited it in a bank.

12. D

- ~~A) Join her colleagues for gym exercise.~~
B) Visit her former university campus.
C) Buy some professional clothes.
D) Budget her salary carefully.

Conversation 2

Questions 13 to 16 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

13. AC

- A) He has just too many things to attend to.
B) He has been overworked recently.
C) He has a difficult decision to make.
D) He has just quarreled with his girlfriend.

14. D

- A) Turn to his girlfriend for assistance.
B) Give priority to things more urgent.
C) Think twice before making the decision.
D) Seek advice from his family and advisor.

15. CD

- ~~A) His girlfriend does not support his decision.~~
B) He is not particularly keen on the job offered.
C) He lacks the money for his doctoral program.
D) His parents and advisor have different opinions.

16. A

- A) They need time to make preparations.
B) They haven't started their careers yet.
C) They need to save enough money for it.
D) They haven't won their parents' approval.

Section C

Directions: In this section, you will hear passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you

hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D) and mark your answers on the ANSWER SHEET.

Passage One

Questions 17 to 23 are based on the passage you have just heard.

17. What is the key to slowing down global warming?

- A) Reducing the production of cars.
- B) Cutting down on consumption of fossil fuels.
- C) Saving water.
- D) Walking instead of driving.

18. Why is it our duty to take action to slow down global warming?

- A) We need to care for our Mother Earth.
- B) We should make sure younger generations will be able to enjoy what the earth can provide for them.
- C) We must shoulder the social responsibility.
- D) We have nothing else to do.

19. Which of the following steps for people to take to drive less was NOT mentioned in the passage?

- A) Walking if it is not far.
- B) Riding a bicycle.
- C) Using public transportation.
- D) Taking a plane if possible.

20. Which of the following steps for people to practice recycling was NOT mentioned in the passage?

- A) Making plastic bags.
- B) Consuming fewer products.
- C) Reusing what they can.
- D) Using canvas totes.

21. According to the passage, why do we need to unplug the appliances?

- A) Because the appliances are too old to work properly.
- B) Because we want to clean the appliances.
- C) Because we need to check the power sockets.

D) Because many appliances that are plugged in still consume energy.

22. According to the passage, why do we need to save water?

- A) Because we want to reduce the cost of water bills.
- B) Because saving water helps to prevent floods.
- C) Because we need to make space for more water in the reservoirs.
- D) Because water companies do not have to expend more energy providing water.

23. What is the main idea of this passage?

- A) The passage mainly talks about the history of global warming.
- B) The passage focuses on the negative impacts of global warming on the environment.
- C) The passage states that we can do something to slow down the process of global warming.
- D) The passage describes the causes of global warming in detail.

Passage Two

Questions 24 to 26 are based on the passage you have just heard.

24. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) The speaker made a bucket list and one of her wishes was to become a ballerina.
- B) The speaker made a bucket list and her biggest dream was to travel around the world.
- C) The speaker made a bucket list and had mixed feelings when achieving her dreams.
- D) The speaker made a bucket list and felt happy to realize most of her dreams.

25. What is the benefit of making a bucket list according to the speaker?

- A) It will force you to think about life in terms of impending death.
- B) It will force you to take a close look at your life.
- C) It will force you to achieve your dreams as early as possible.
- D) It will force you to think about death at an early age.

26. How many of the speaker's dreams are listed in the passage?

- A) 3.
- B) 5.
- C) 4.
- D) 6.

Passage Three

Questions 27 to 30 are based on the passage you have just heard.

27. What did the boy Jude Sparks think he had discovered?

- A) A rare animal.
- B) A historical site.
- C) A cow bone.
- D) A precious stone.

28. What are the researchers at New Mexico State University doing with the boy's discovery?

- A) Dating it.
- B) Preserving it.
- C) Measuring it.
- D) Identifying it.

29. What did Professor Peter Horde say when interviewed by ABC news?

- A) The channel needs to interview the boy.
- B) The boy should have called an expert.
- C) The boy's family had acted correctly.
- D) The site should have been protected.

30. What do the researchers plan to do?

- A) Conduct a more detailed search.
- B) Ask the university to reward Jude.
- C) Search for similar fossils elsewhere.
- D) Seek additional funds for the search.

Part II Reading Comprehension

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Section A (15 points, 1.5 points each)

Directions: In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to

it Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet.

I Cry, Therefore I Am

- A) In 2008, at a German zoo, a *gorilla* named Gana gave birth to a male infant, who died after three months. Photographs of Gana, looking stricken and inconsolable (伤心欲绝的), attracted crowds to the zoo. Sad as the scene was, the humans, not Gana, were the only ones crying. The notion that animals can weep has no scientific basis. Years of observations by biologists Dian Fossey, who observed gorillas, and Jane Goodall, who worked with *chimpanzees*, could not prove that animals cry tears from emotion.
- B) It's true that many animals shed tears, especially in response to pain. Tears protect the eye by keeping it moist. But crying as an expression of feeling is unique to humans and has played an essential role in human evolution and the development of human cultures.
- C) Within two days an infant can imitate sad and happy faces. If an infant does not cry out, it is unlikely to get the attention it needs to survive. Around 3-4 months, the relationship between the human infant and its environment takes on a more organized communicative role, and tearful crying begins to serve interpersonal purposes: the search for comfort and *pacification* (抚慰). As we get older, crying becomes a tool of social interaction: grief and joy, shame and pride, fear and manipulation.
- D) Tears are as universal as laughter, and grief is more complex than joy. But although we all cry, we do so in different ways. Women cry more frequently and intensely than men, especially when exposed to emotional events. Like crying, depression is, around the world, more commonly seen in women than in men. One explanation might be that women, who despite decades of social advances still suffer from economic inequality, *discrimination* (歧视) and even violence, might have more to cry about. Men not only cry for shorter periods than women, but they also are less inclined to explain their tears, usually shed them more quietly, and tend more frequently to apologize when they cry openly. Men, like women, report crying at the death of a loved one and in response to a moving religious experience. They are more likely than women to cry when their core identities—as providers and protectors, as fathers and fighters—are questioned.
- E) People who score on personality tests as more sympathetic cry more than those who are more rigid or have more self-control. Frequency of crying varies widely: some shed tears at any novel or movie, others only a handful of times in their lives. Crying in response to stress and conflict in the home, or after emotional *trauma* (创伤), lasts

much longer than tears induced by everyday sadness—which in turn last longer than tears of delight and joy.

- F) Sadness is our primary association with crying, but the fact is that people report feeling happier after crying. Surveys estimate that 85% of women and 73% of men report feeling better after shedding tears. Surprisingly, crying is more commonly associated with minor forms of depression than with major depression involving suicidal thoughts.
- G) People widely report that crying relieves tension, restores emotional balance and provides “catharsis,” a washing out of bad feelings. The term “catharsis” has religious implications of removing evil and sin; it’s no surprise that religious ceremonies are, around the world, one of the main settings for the release of tears.
- H) Crying is a nearly universal sign of grief, though some mourners report that, despite genuine sorrow, they cannot shed tears—sometimes even for years after their loved one has gone. Unlike today, when the privacy of grief is more respected, the public or ceremonial shedding of tears, at the graveside of a spouse or the funeral of a king or queen, was once considered socially or even politically essential.
- I) Crying has also served other social purposes. Rousseau wrote in his *Confessions* that while he considered tears the most powerful expression of love, he also just liked to cry over nothing.
- J) The association of tears with art has ancient roots. The classic Greek tragedies of the fifth century B. C. were primarily celebrations of gods. Tragedies, like poetry and music, were staged religious events. Even then it was recognized that crying in response to drama brought pleasure.
- K) I have argued that there are *neurobiological* (神经生物方面的) associations linking the arts and mood disorders. When I lecture on crying, I ask my audience to let me know, by a show of hands, which art forms most move them to tears. About 80% say music, followed closely by novels (74%), but then the figures fall sharply, to 43%, for poetry, and 10-22% for paintings, sculpture and architecture.
- L) The physical act of crying is mainly one of breathing in air, which is why we choke up when we weep. This suggests to language scientists that emotional crying evolved before language, perhaps explaining why tears communicate states of mind and feelings that are often so difficult to express in words. Of course, from an evolutionary perspective, recognition of emotion (usually through facial gesture) was essential for survival.
- M) The earliest humans arrived several million years ago, but only 150,000 to 200,000 years ago, did cultures, language, religion and the arts arise. Along the way, tears became more than a biological necessity to lubricate (润滑) the eye and developed into a sign of intense emotion and a signal of social bonding. The development of

self-consciousness and the notion of individual identity, or ego; storytelling about the origins of the world, the creation of humanity and life after death; and the ability to feel others' sadness—all were critical parts of the neurobiological changes that made us human.

- N) More recently, we've learned from neuroscience that certain brain *circuits* (回路) are *activated* (激活), rapidly and unconsciously, when we see another in emotional distress. In short, our brain evolved circuits to allow us to experience sympathy, which in turn made civilization, and an ethics based on sympathy, possible.
- O) ~~So~~ the next time you reach a tissue box, or sob on a Mend's shoulder, or shed tears at the movies, stop and reflect on why we cry and what it means to cry. Because ultimately, while we love to cry, we also cry to love.

H 31. Nowadays people respect the privacy of grief more than in the past.

C 32. Infants cry to attract attention for survival.

L 33. There is no scientific evidence as yet that animals can shed tears from emotion.

N 34. Tears can perform certain communicative functions which words cannot

F 35. Our ability to experience sympathy is essential to the development of civilization.

H 36. People are more inclined to cry when suffering minor forms of depression.

M 37. Sometimes people cannot cry despite genuine grief.

I 38. In humans' history, tears have developed an essential role in social relationships

J 39. Men are less likely to give reasons for their tears.

J 40. Crying has long been associated with art.

Section B (20 points, 2 points each)

Directions: There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions. For each of them there are four choices. You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the center.

Passage One

Questions 41 to 45 are based on the following passage.

The phrase almost completes itself: midlife crisis. It's the stage in the middle of the journey when people feel youth vanishing, their prospects narrowing and death approaching.

There's only one problem with the cliché. It isn't true.

“In fact, there is almost no hard evidence for midlife crisis other than a few small pilot studies conducted decades ago,” Barbara Hagerty writes in her new book, *Life Reimagined*. The vast bulk of the research shows that there may be a pause, or a shifting of gears in the 40s or 50s, but this shift “can be exciting, rather than terrifying”.

Barbara Hagerty looks at some of the features of people who turn midlife into a rebirth. They break routines, because “autopilot is death”. They choose purpose over happiness—having a clear sense of purpose even reduces the risk of Alzheimer’s disease. They give priority to relationships, as careers often recede.

Life Reimagined paints a picture of middle age that is far from gloomy. Midlife seems like the second big phase of decision-making. Your identity has been formed; you’ve built up your resources; and now you have the chance to take the big risks precisely because your foundation is already secure.

Karl Barth described midlife precisely this way. At middle age, he wrote, “the sowing is behind; now is the time to reap. The run has been taken; now is the time to leap. Preparation has been made; now is the time for the venture of the work itself.”

The middle-aged person, Barth continued, can see death in the distance, but moves with a “measured haste” to get big new things done while there is still time.

What Barth wrote decades ago is even truer today. People are healthy and energetic longer. We have presidential candidates running for their first term in office at age 68, 69 and 74. A longer lifespan is changing the narrative structure of life itself. What could have been considered the beginning of a descent is now a potential turning point—the turning point you are most equipped to take full advantage of.

41. What does the author think of the phrase “midlife crisis”?

- ☒ A) It has led to a lot of debate.
- ☒ B) It is widely acknowledged.
- ☐ C) It is no longer fashionable.
- ☐ D) It misrepresents real life.

42. How does Barbara Hagerty view midlife?

- ☒ A) It may be the beginning of a crisis.
- ☒ B) It can be a new phase of one’s life.
- ☒ C) It can be terrifying for the unprepared.
- ☒ D) It may see old-age diseases approaching.

A 43. How is midlife pictured in the book Life Reimagined?

- A) It can be quite rosy.
- B) It can be burdensome.
- C) It undergoes radical transformation.
- D) It makes for the best part of one's life.

C 44. According to Karl Barth, midlife is the time _____.

- A) to relax
- B) to mature
- C) to harvest
- D) to reflect

D 45. What does the author say about midlife today?

- A) It is more meaningful than other stages of life.
- B) It is likely to change the narrative of one's life.
- C) It is more important to those with a longer lifespan.
- D) It is likely to be a critical turning point in one's life.

Passage Two

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

High-quality customer service is preached by many, but actually keeping customers happy is easier said than done.

Shoppers seldom complain to the manager or owner of a retail store, but instead will alert their friends, relatives, co-workers, strangers-and anyone who will listen.

Store managers are often the last to hear complaints, and often find out only when their regular customers decide to frequent their competitors, according to a study jointly conducted by Verde group and Wharton school.

"Storytelling hurts retailers and entertains consumers," said Paula Courtney, President of the Verde group. "the store loses the customer, but the shopper must also find a replacement."

On average, every unhappy customer will complain to at least four others, and will no longer visit the specific store for every dissatisfied customer, a store will lose up to three more due to negative reviews. The resulting "snowball effect" can be disastrous to retailers.

According to the research, shoppers who purchased clothing encountered the most

problems. Ranked second and third were grocery and electronics customers.

The most common complaints include filled parking lots, cluttered shelves, overloaded racks, out-of-stock items, long check-out lines, and rude salespeople.

During peak shopping hours, some retailers solved the parking problems by getting moonlighting local police to work as parking attendants. Some hired flag wavers to direct customers to empty parking spaces. This guidance eliminated the need for customers to circle the parking lot endlessly, and avoided confrontation between those eyeing the same parking space.

Retailers can relieve the headaches by redesigning store layouts, pre-stocking sales items, hiring speedy and experienced cashiers, and having sales representatives on hand to answer questions.

Most importantly, salespeople should be diplomatic and polite with angry customers.

"Retailers who're responsive and friendly are more likely to smooth over issues than those who aren't so friendly." said Professor Stephen Hoch. "Maybe something as simple as a greeter at the store entrance would help."

Customers can also improve future shopping experiences by filing complaints to the retailer, instead of complaining to the rest of the world. Retailers are hard-pressed to improve when they have no idea what is wrong.

46. Why are store managers often the last to hear complaints?

- A) Most customers won't bother to complain even if they have had unhappy experiences.
- B) Customers would rather relate their unhappy experiences to people around them.
- C) Few customers believe the service will be improved.
- D) Customers have no easy access to store managers.

47. What does Paula Courtney imply by saying "... the shopper must also find a replacement" (Line 2, Para. 4) ?

- A) New customers are bound to replace old ones.
- B) It is not likely the shopper can find the same products in other stores.
- C) Most stores provide the same.
- D) Not complaining to the manager causes the shopper some trouble too.

48. Shop owners often hire moonlighting police as parking attendants so that shoppers _____

- A) can stay longer browsing in the store.
- B) won't have trouble parking their cars.

- ~~C) won't have any worries about security.~~
D) can find their cars easily after shopping.

49. What contributes most to smoothing over issues with customers?

- A) Manners of the salespeople.
~~B) Hiring of efficient employees.~~
C) Huge supply of goods for sale.
~~D) Design of the store layout.~~

50. To achieve better shopping experiences, customers are advised to _____.

- A) exert pressure on stores to improve their service
~~B) settle their disputes with stores in a diplomatic way~~
C) voice their dissatisfaction to store managers directly
~~D) shop around and make comparisons between stores~~

Part III Vocabulary and Structure (20 points, 1 point each)

得分

Directions: Each of the following 20 sentences has four choices. You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the center.

51. With the expansion of Chinese viewers, many Western filmmakers have started to _____ Chinese elements in their products to meet Chinese audiences' needs.

- A) hold B) compose C) incorporate D) digest

52. The researcher needs to inform the readers that the _____ of the study is confined to a preliminary stage, otherwise it will create a lot of ambiguity about the research goals.

- A) extent B) span C) scale D) scope

53. KFC _____ served only a few items but now offers more than 140. Yet the restaurants' revenue fell by 11 percent in the first quarter of 2015.

- A) tangibly B) glaringly C) initially D) primarily

54. Richard Nixon was the 37th U.S. president and the only commander-in-chief who

_____ from his post because of the 1970s Watergate scandal.

- A) designed B) resigned C) assigned D) consigned

17 55. During the class discussion, the teacher _____ Maria for her creative approach, though it made her feel slightly uncomfortable being the only one praised.

- A) brought about B) looked up C) turned down D) singled out

C 56. He condemned the _____ of those politicians who do one thing and say another.

- A) quandary B) disloyalty C) hypocrisy D) arrogance

12 57. The rapid _____ of artificial intelligence in healthcare has revolutionized diagnostic methods, though ethical concerns remain.

- A) adaptation B) adoption C) addiction D) admiration

A 58. In chemical equations, the arrow symbol ($\rightarrow$) is used to _____ a reaction proceeding in one direction under specific conditions.

- A) denote B) display C) predict D) imitate

A 59. Recent data shows that renewable energy production has _____ fossil fuel usage in several European countries, marking a historic shift.

- A) balanced B) approached C) maintained D) surpassed

C 60. To accelerate vaccine development, multiple pharmaceutical companies agreed to _____ their research resources and expertise.

- A) pool B) collect C) distribute D) waste

C 61. The _____ of smartphones in modern society has fundamentally altered how people access information and communicate.

- A) rarity B) solidity C) ubiquity D) complexity

13 62. After months of preparation, the research team decided to _____ on a groundbreaking project exploring deep-sea ecosystems.

~~A) begin~~ B) embark ~~C) initiate~~ ~~D) launch~~

63. Effective social workers must possess strong _____ to truly understand the struggles faced by marginalized communities.

~~A) empathy~~ ~~B) sympathy~~ ~~C) curiosity~~ D) optimism

64. The university's new interdisciplinary program aims to _____ fields as diverse as robotics, ethics, and environmental science.

A) memorize B) exclude C) simplify D) encompass

65. Career advisors often encourage graduates to _____ with professionals in their field to explore job opportunities.

~~A) network~~ ~~B) navigate~~ C) recruit ~~D) smear~~

66. The tech startup plans to _____ a new app next month, targeting young professionals seeking efficient time management tools.

A) introduce B) submit C) launch D) emit

66. The board members were unanimously _____ the CEO's proposal to invest in renewable energy, believing it aligned with long-term goals.

A) supportive of B) critical of C) aware of D) approve of

68. The scholarship requires students to _____ community service hours while maintaining a high GPA.

~~A) accomplish~~ ~~B) fulfill~~ ~~C) meet~~ D) satisfy

69. As the hikers reached the mountain's _____, they were rewarded with a breathtaking view of the valley below.

A) crest B) base C) slope D) crave

70. He had an _____ sense of what the reader wanted.

A) informative B) institutional C) instructive D) intuitive

Part IV Cloze (15 points, 1.5 points each)

得分

Directions: In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the center. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.

It is often said that grades and MCAT (Medical College Admission Test) scores don't get people into medical school, they keep people out. Without a good GPA and MCAT score, it is virtually 71 A to secure a spot in medical school, but having good grades and test scores alone is not enough to 72 F acceptance. Along with academics, premedical students should also engage in a number of activities that make their background 73 E to admissions committees.

Extensive exposure to clinical medicine is 74 B the most vital element of a medical school application, aside from strong grades and test scores. This can be volunteer work in a clinic or hospital or a paid position as a medical assistant. Contrary to popular 75 D, medical schools don't want premedical students to 76 K in clinical work to learn medical science. The medical field is vast and the body of knowledge you need to know to practice medicine cannot be 77 G by spending time as a medical assistant.

Aspiring doctors are 78 J to gain clinical exposure so they can learn more about the profession and make an informed decision before 79 D themselves to the long path of training as a physician. The best clinical opportunities are those that give applicants the chance to work alongside physicians and get a 80 C into the day to day lives of medical doctors.

- A) committing
B) arguably
C) relief

- D) ensure
J) expected
K) belief

~~D) assure~~

~~E) compelling~~

~~F) primarily~~

~~G) inadequate~~ 不充足

~~H) participate~~

~~L) impossible~~

~~M) glimpse~~

~~N) succeed~~

~~O) acquired~~